

CMV CT-522A

The CMV CT-522A was amongst the best performers when it came to detail and colour reproduction. The 'auto' setting button is featured. It's ideal for SoHo and corporate office use—it has a better brightness and contrast range, and is also good at reproducing finer details. Home users, too, can consider this monitor, given the competitive price tag of Rs 20,000.



The power rating is 33 W, which is in line with other LCDs. The monitor looks decent, with a dual-tone black and silver-grey body. The bottom support is firm, which is important for equipment as delicate as an LCD panel.

The speakers are rated at 1.5 W, which is good enough for system sounds—but not really for music, for which we recommend getting separate speakers.

+ Firm bottom support, 'auto' button for screen adjustment

– Speakers not adequate

Price: Rs. 16,500

Philips 150C was the most energy-efficient, with a power consumption of only 18W, compared to the 40W typically consumed by 15-inch CRTs. The BenQ FP567s, meanwhile, is the most power hungry-panel—it needs a good 40 watts.

But when it comes to looks, nothing beats the BenQ FP567s—it comes loaded with a white front panel, a black stand, and a silver-grey strip at the bottom that houses the speakers and buttons. The Samsung SyncMaster 152s has a sophisticated look, making it more suitable for corporates: the body is dual-tone silver-grey and black, with tiny chrome-plated buttons.

Performance

With a new monitor, the first think you'd probably look at, and the first thing you'll definitely be shown, are the features.

Caveat Emptor. Never ever ignore performance. We used DisplayMate Video Edition to test performance, as well as other miscellaneous tests, to bring out the performance issues and highlights of each monitor.

The point shape and visibility test is important for any kind of user, because it checks how well a monitor displays a detail as small as a dot. It checks, for example, whether the monitor displays a black full-stop as a black full-stop, or as a small square in a different colour. The Samsung 152s was ahead of the rest: a round white dot appeared perfectly round and white, without additional colours—red, green or blue—visible at the edge, which is not the case with most of the other panels.

However, most panels performed reasonably well in this test,

with very little pixel bleeding at the edges. The CMV CT-522A also returned acceptable results, albeit with some slight bleeding at the edges.

As for video bandwidth, the higher it is the better, but all the panels we tested had a rated bandwidth of 80 MHz. In the video bandwidth test, we use thin white lines separated from each other by a distance of just one pixel, and we then try to see whether the lines appear distinct.

The Samsung 152s performed very well here, and we could see the lines as distinct even from a distance of 2 to 3 feet. We therefore recommend the 152s to users of page layout software, or, for example, fashion designers, since the monitor displays the finest of details. Some panels, such as the Philips 150X didn't perform too well—the lines could not be distinguished, and looked like a single block.

The Samsung 152s, along with the CMV CT-522A and Philips 150X, did not display any streaking or ghosting. This is good for people who work mostly on documents and spreadsheets, where bright and dark areas can be adjacent to each other.

These three panels are also good for movie-watching, because there won't be shadowing on the screen. In the white and black level shift test, there's a sharp edge between a white and a grey block. The CMV CT-522A performed very well here. Graphic artists would be interested in this, because

NEC AccuSync LCD51V	Philips 150C	Philips 150X	Samsung SyncMaster 152s	Viewsonic VE155s
0.297	0.297	0.297	0.297	0.297
250	250	250	250	250
400:1	400:1	400:1	350:1	400:1
56 - 75	56 - 76	56 - 76	56 - 75	50 - 75
31.5 - 60	30 - 61	30 - 61	30 - 61	30 - 62
1024 x 768	1024 x 768	1024 x 768	1024 x 768	1024 x 768
NA	80	80	80	80
25	30	25	25	30
347.4 x 341.9 x 183.5	360 x 356 x 177	360 x 358 x 177	357.5 x 346.7 x 184.5	356 x 344 x 200
3	4.55	4.63	2.9	3.7
N	N	1 W RMS	N	N
Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
N/Y	N/Y	N/Y	N/Y	N/Y
24	18	20	31	30
Manual, power cord	Power cord	Power cord	Manual, data cable, audio cable, power cord, power adapter, wall-mount accessories, natural colour software, driver	Driver, manual on CD, quick start guide, data cable, power cord
6.25	6.25	6.25	7.5	6
39.5	34.25	37	36.25	36.25
150	150	150	150	150
4	3.75	3.25	4	4
3.75	3	3	4	3.75
21	18	20	22	20
29.3	27.32	28.08	29.8	28.65
58.10	51.33	55.49	58.45	55.35
2.58	2.44	2.52	2.69	3.08
22,500	21,000	22,000	21,720	18,000
B-	B-	B-	B-	B